

In his cinematic adventures to date, Tony Stark has traveled to Monaco, the Middle East, Germany, and even outer space. For *Iron Man 3*, Marvel Studios and director Shane Black faced a tough challenge: Where do you send the man who's been everywhere?

How about rural Tennessee?

Early in the film, Tony drops in—literally, out of the sky—on the sleepy little town of Rosehill, Tennessee. There he finds a team of Extremis agents already waiting for him and embarks on a sequence of events that will change his life forever.

Of course, Rosehill is only one stop on Tony Stark's latest odyssey. The search for the Mandarin leads Tony across the country from Malibu to Miami—where he finds a lush, opulent mansion. This wide variety of settings kept the *Iron Man 3* crew on their jet-booted toes.

"It was all over the place, but that's what we do," Production Designer Bill Brzeski says. "We shot the movie in Wilmington, North Carolina, and we had to find our locations within a driving zone of there—a two-hour radius of the city. So we broke down all the locations we could possibly find in Wilmington, North Carolina, which wasn't everything.

"We went up to Raleigh to do the headquarters for Stark Industries, because there's some very high-tech buildings up there. The seaport, in the finale, was fortuitous. We tried to find something in Miami—but lo and behold, there was a brand-new seaport in Wilmington."

The Seaport provides the setting for the film's breathtaking, climactic aerial battle.

After racking up so many frequent-flier miles, only one question remains for Tony: Where on Earth can he go next?



Art by Rob McKinnon.